

GEC 106: ART APPRECIATION

Comprehensive Examination & Course Reviewer

ACADEMIC REFERENCE • MODULES 1 – 6 • FULL CURRICULUM

MODULE 1

Introduction to Art & Humanities

1. ETYMOLOGY AND DEFINITIONS OF HUMANITIES

The term **Humanities** is derived from the Latin word *humanus*, which directly translates to **refined**, **cultured**, and **human**.

Refined

Possessing proper etiquette, decorum, civility, and social graces in human conduct.

Cultured

Adapting effectively to one's social environment, cultural norms, and interpersonal interactions.

Evolution of Aims Across Historical Eras:

- **Medieval Age:** Focused primarily on the metaphysics of religious philosophy (the systematic investigation of ultimate reality and divine order).
- **Renaissance Period:** Aimed to enrich man culturally, as fine art creation (paintings, sculptures) was largely sponsored by and accessible to the wealthy elite.
- **19th–20th Century:** Aimed to understand and appreciate human existence, individual ideas, and social aspirations.

2. ASPECTS OF HUMAN NATURE

- **Rational Being:** Equipped with intellect and reasoning powers; acts based on logic, critical analysis, and judgment rather than pure impulse.
- **Emotional Being:** Possesses deep feelings, empathy, and the capacity to love, alongside the requirement to exercise emotional control.
- **Spiritual Being:** Composed of both physical body and soul; acknowledges an existence and higher truth beyond the temporal, physical world.
- **Social / Relational Being:** Driven by an essential, intrinsic need for genuine interpersonal connection, community, and belonging.
- **Freewill & Freedom:**
 - *Freewill:* The capacity of the human mind to make choices and independent decisions.
 - *Freedom:* The moral agency and responsibility to choose and execute what is good and right.

Fields Related to Humanities & Definitions of Art

3. FIELDS RELATED TO HUMANITIES

Anthropology

The holistic study of human societies, cultures, and biological evolution.

Sociology

The study of social development, structures, and functioning of human society.

Philosophy

Investigation of fundamental questions on existence, knowledge, values, and reason.

Religion

System of beliefs, sacred rituals, and worship of a controlling power or deity.

History

The systematic study, recording, and interpretation of past human events.

Literature

Written works valued for artistic, expressive, or intellectual merit.

4. ETYMOLOGY AND CONCEPT OF ART

Traced to the 13th-century French word *art* (skill acquired through practice) and the Latin *ars* (ability or practical skill).

Three Dimensions of Art:

As Ability

The inherent human capacity and creative power to design and make objects of beauty.

As Process

The active execution of creation (drawing, painting, sculpting, designing, performing).

As Product

The completed artistic artifact or work (etching, sculpture, structure, composition).

5. NOTABLE PHILOSOPHICAL DEFINITIONS OF ART

Thinker / Author	Philosophical Perspective / Definition
Plato	"Art is that which brings life in harmony with the beauty of the world."
John Dewey	"Art is an attitude of spirit, a state of mind—one that demands for its own satisfaction and fulfilling, a shaping of matter to new and more significant form."
Oscar Wilde	"Art is the most intense mode of individualism that the world has known."
Elbert Hubbard	"Art is not a thing—it is a way."

Essentials of Art & Art History

6. FOUR COMMON ESSENTIALS OF ART

1. **Man-Made:** Art is strictly created by human design, thought, and effort, distinguishing it from untouched natural phenomena.
2. **Creative, Not Imitative:** Authentic art involves original human expression and imaginative synthesis rather than mere mechanical copying.
3. **Satisfies Human Needs:** Art fulfills essential psychological, emotional, aesthetic, intellectual, or practical needs.
4. **Expressed Through a Medium:** Art relies on physical or sensory media (pigment, sound, words, body movement, bronze) to transmit meaning.

MODULE 2

Art History & Major Assumptions

1. ART HISTORY

The academic study of artworks within their historical context, stylistic evolution, genre, format, and design across both **major arts** (painting, sculpture, architecture) and **minor arts** (ceramics, furniture, decorative crafts). Art appreciation allows viewers to form grounded critical judgments.

2. THREE MAJOR ASSUMPTIONS OF ART

1. Art is Universal: Art exists across all human civilizations and historical epochs. It transcends cultural, racial, and geographical boundaries because it addresses shared human conditions.

2. Art is Not Nature: Art is an artificial human creation. A work of art does not transform on its own unless altered by a human, whereas nature is divine, living, and self-transforming.

3. Art Involves Experience: Art cannot be fully grasped through purely abstract or second-hand knowledge; it requires direct sensory engagement—looking, listening, touching, or participating.

Functions & Classifications of Art

3. FIVE PRIMARY FUNCTIONS OF ART

1. Personal Function

Serves individual emotional expression, relaxation, personal comfort, self-reflection, and self-actualization.

2. Social Function

Addresses collective human experience, public commemoration, civic unity, political expression, and social commentary.

3. Cultural Function

Preserves, transmits, and celebrates a society's heritage, oral traditions, customs, shared values, and historical memory.

4. Aesthetic Function

Elevates human perception, awareness, and appreciation of visual beauty, harmony, composition, and sensory delight.

5. Spiritual Function

Reinforces religious devotion, sacred rituals, spiritual connection, and reverence for the divine within a culture.

MODULE 3

Categories of Art

1. VISUAL ARTS (2D AND 3D)

- **Painting:** Applying color pigments to a two-dimensional flat surface (e.g., Botticelli's *Birth of Venus*, Michelangelo's *The Creation of Adam*).
- **Sculpture:** Modeling, carving, casting, or assembling materials into three-dimensional forms (e.g., *Nefertiti Bust*, *Thalia Bust*).
- **Architecture:** The art and science of planning, designing, and constructing 3D structures for shelter and human activity.

2. PERFORMING / COMBINED ARTS

Music & Dance

Organizing sound/rhythm in time; rhythmic body movement in space to express emotion.

Theater & Film

Live dramatic stage enactments; sequential still frames projected rapidly to create motion.

- **Literary Arts & Performance Poetry:** Written prose/poetry crafted for aesthetic value, or spoken-word compositions created specifically for live audience engagement.

Digital & Applied Arts; Elements of Line

3. DIGITAL ART & 4. APPLIED ARTS

Digital Art: Artistic works or practices created or modified using electronic devices and computer technology.

Applied Arts: Integrating artistic principles and aesthetics into everyday functional objects:

Fashion Design

Crafting apparel and lifestyle accessories combining visual appeal and utility.

Furniture Design

Blending ergonomic functionality with clean aesthetic forms for interior spaces.

Interior Design

Enhancing indoor architectural environments for safety, health, and aesthetic quality.

Graphic Design

Combining typography, imagery, and symbols for visual communication media.

MODULE 4

Elements of Visual Arts: Line

1. LINE CONCEPT & STRAIGHT LINES

Line is a fundamental element possessing direction, defining boundaries, and guiding visual movement.

Straight Lines: Structural and firm; express stability but lack organic flexibility.

Horizontal Lines

Suggest calmness, repose, serenity, and stability (e.g., quiet horizon, resting figure).

Vertical Lines

Express height, strength, poise, elevation, and dignity (e.g., Parthenon columns, cathedrals).

Diagonal Lines: Indicate dynamic movement and action. *Positive diagonals* convey dynamic energy (running athlete), while *adverse diagonals* denote defeat or collapse (falling soldiers).

Zigzag Lines

Alternating diagonals in rapid sequence signifying chaos, violence, conflict, and confusion.

Curved Lines, Relationships, & Color Fundamentals

2. CURVED LINES (CURVILINEAR)

Smooth, natural, and organic; display flexibility, grace, and subtle movement.

- Convey fluid motion, joyousness, elegance, and delicacy.
- **Spiral Lines:** Curves wrapping continuously around a central point (e.g., nautilus shells).
- **Wavy Lines:** Alternating soft curves producing rhythmic, continuous movement.
- *Historical Example:* Restrained curves depicting the female form and bamboo stems in Carlos "Botong" Francisco's depiction of the *Malakas at Maganda* legend.

3. CROOKED LINES & LINE RELATIONSHIPS

1. Lines that follow or repeat one another to build rhythmic structure.
2. Lines that contrast directly with one another to generate visual tension.
3. Transitional lines that modify, connect, or soften surrounding sharp elements.

Repetition

Systematic drawing of two or more lines within a space to emphasize direction.

Organic Unity

Harmonious linear arrangement yielding overall balance, rhythm, and proportion.

4. FUNDAMENTALS OF COLOR (HUE)

- **Hue:** The technical name of a color based on its light wavelength position.
- **Color Temperature:**
 - *Warm Colors (Reds, Oranges, Yellows):* Associated with sun and fire; evoke energy, visually advancing forward.
 - *Cool Colors (Blues, Greens, Violets):* Associated with water and shade; evoke calm, visually receding into background.
- **Color Value:** Relative lightness or darkness of a hue.
 - *Tint:* Value lighter than normal (hue + white; e.g., Pink is a tint of red).
 - *Shade:* Value darker than normal (hue + black; e.g., Maroon is a shade of red).
- **Intensity (Saturation):** The purity, strength, or vividness of a color.

Color Psychology & Rose Symbolism

5. SYMBOLISM AND PSYCHOLOGY OF COLORS

Color	Psychological Association & Symbolism
Black	Gloom, despair, death, mourning, pain, formality, and darkness.
White	Purity, innocence, clarity, simplicity, peace, and truth.
Blue	Peace, tranquility, calmness, heaven, deep water, loyalty, and serenity.
Red	Passion, intense energy, warmth, bravery, fire, blood, anger, and danger.
Orange	Assertiveness, cheerfulness, vitality, warmth, and sweetness.
Green	Nature, growth, freshness, health, renewal, hope, and fertility.
Yellow	Joy, sunshine, warmth, hospitality, splendor, and intellectual vibrancy.
Yellow-Green	Jealousy, sickness, envy, and hatred.
Violet	Royalty, power, penance, mystery, spiritual depth, and shadow.
Brown	Humility, earthiness, stability, confidence, and warmth.

6. MEANING OF ROSE COLORS

Deep Pink

Expresses deep gratitude, appreciation, and heartfelt thanks ("Thank you").

Light Pink

Symbolizes gentleness, grace, sympathy, sweetness, and admiration.

Red Rose

Denotes romantic love ("I love you"), courage, fortitude, and passion.

Presenting Subjects & Creative Process

1. WAYS OF PRESENTING ART SUBJECTS

1. Realism: Portraying the subject exactly as it appears in objective reality without distortion or artificial idealization (e.g., Gustave Courbet's *The Meeting*).

2. Abstraction: Emphasizing internal ideas, concepts, feelings, or non-representational shapes over physical accuracy (e.g., Hernando R. Ocampo).

3. Distortion: Deliberately altering, exaggerating, or twisting natural proportions to dramatize emotion or generate psychological impact (e.g., Caricatures).

2. THE CREATIVE PROCESS (ROBERT FRITZ MODEL)

Creation is a learnable, structured skill honed through practical application and discipline.

Five Core Steps in the Creative Process:

1. **Conceive the Result:** Formulate a crisp, clear mental vision of the final creative outcome desired.
2. **Know What Currently Exists:** Research existing works in the field to build an informed, original foundation.
3. **Take Action:** Execute tangible, decisive steps to translate theoretical concepts into physical manifestation.
4. **Develop Creativity:** Gain deeper insights, mastery, and self-knowledge through active hands-on practice.
5. **Learn the Rhythms:** Master the natural progression through the three fundamental creative stages.

3. THREE FUNDAMENTAL STAGES OF CREATION

1. Germination (Idea)

Initial spark of inspiration where seeds of the project are planted with excitement.

2. Assimilation

Internalizing, structuring, analyzing, and cultivating the idea through focused labor.

3. Completion

Applying final refinements, polishing work to meet standards, and celebrating.

Artists, Artisans, & National Honors

1. ARTIST VS. ARTISAN

The Artist

A creative practitioner (painter, sculptor, musician, poet) focused on *indirect functionality*. Expresses emotions, personal concepts, and aesthetics.

The Artisan

A skilled craftsman (carpenter, weaver, blacksmith, carver) producing *directly functional objects* necessary for daily utility (furniture, tools, shelter).

2. ORDER OF NATIONAL ARTISTS

The highest national recognition conferred upon Filipino individuals who have made pioneering contributions to Philippine arts. Administered jointly by the **NCCA** and the **Cultural Center of the Philippines (CCP)**.

Selection Criteria for National Artist:

1. Filipino citizenship at nomination (or at death for post-1972 awardees).
2. Significant contribution to building a Filipino sense of nationhood.
3. Pioneering impact on succeeding generations of artists.
4. Substantial body of work displaying technical mastery and artistic excellence.
5. Widespread critical acclaim and peer recognition at national/international levels.

3. GAWAD SA MANLILIKHA NG BAYAN (GAMABA)

The **National Living Treasures Award**, institutionalized under **RA No. 7335** (administered by NCCA) to honor traditional indigenous artisans.

Selection Criteria & Duties:

- Member of an indigenous community preserving traditional crafts for at least 50 years with extraordinary technical mastery.
- **Duties:** (1) Transfer traditional skills to youth; (2) Cooperate with NCCA; (3) Donate a representative masterpiece to the National Museum.

Featured GAMABA Awardees & Summary

FEATURED GAMABA AWARDEES

Awardee	Origin / Group	Art Form & Major Cultural Contribution	Year
Ginaw Bilog	Hanunuo Mangyan <i>Mansalay, Mindoro</i>	Master of the Ambahan —a traditional 7-syllable Mangyan poetic form etched onto bamboo tubes conveying symbolic life lessons.	1993
Lang Dulay	T'boli <i>Lake Sebu, South Cotabato</i>	Master weaver of traditional T'nalak cloth crafted from fine abaca fibers; featured at the Smithsonian Institution.	1996
Federico Caballero	Panay-Bukidnon <i>Central Panay</i>	Epic chanter who systematically documented ten oral epics (Sugidanon series, including <i>Tikum Kadlum</i>) in an archaic language.	2000
Alonzo Saclag	Kalinga <i>Lubuagan, Kalinga</i>	Master of Kalinga dance and performing arts; founder of the <i>Kalinga Budong Dance Troupe</i> and creator of the <i>Awichon</i> cultural village.	2000 / 2016
Magdalena Gamayo	Ilocano <i>Pinili, Ilocos Norte</i>	Master weaver of traditional Inabel fabric; renowned for complex patterns including <i>Kusikus</i> (whirlwind) and <i>Sinan paddak ti pusa</i> (cat's pawprint).	2012

Final Reviewer Summary Note

Art Appreciation (GEC 106) encompasses the humanistic understanding of creative expression across cultures, mediums, and history. Mastery of this reviewer requires understanding the dual nature of art as both universal and deeply rooted in personal/cultural experience, recognizing visual elements (lines, colors, forms), understanding creative processes, and honoring national artistic heritage (Order of National Artists & GAMABA).